

A GIFT FROM THE MASTERCLASS

Stories of Mothers Who Raised Great Men

*Five shepherds. Five grand visions. Five
sons who became lights for the ummah.*

ARIBA FARHEEN



BEFORE THE STORIES

Inspired Mothers and Vision

As-salamu alaykum, sister.

In the masterclass, I promised you this book, and here it is. Thank you for showing up for your child. You are among the very few in the whole world who are worried not only about your child's dunya but about their akhirah too, and that alone tells me exactly who you are.

Before you read a single story, I want to remind you of the one shift I showed you. Your child should not be someone you have to push towards Salah, Quran, and everything good. Your child should be someone who goes to it willingly, out of love for Allah, whether you are watching or not. The mothers in this book made that shift long before anyone had a name for it. They knew how to steer the heart, and every one of them did it with a vision.

Mothers who raise great Muslims all have one thing in common: they are mothers of a grand vision. That vision pulls them to raise their standards, and it shapes them into the kind of woman who can actually make the dream real.

I see this so often. A mother begins with beautiful dreams and high hopes for her baby. But as the child grows to 10, then 13, then 17, those dreams start to fade under the weight of daily struggles and challenges. By this point, she tells herself that she is simply "doing her best." Or worse, she tells herself, "My kids are good kids, they will be fine," which might be the most dangerous sentence a mother can say in this age.

But what does "doing your best" really mean? Our best is not fixed. We have to keep raising it, and we have to keep raising what we even call our best. So how do we do that?

The same way we do it for our children. We need role models, and we need friends who are ahead of us, people who lift the bar for us.

Remember what I told you about friends. The Prophet ﷺ said a person is on the deen of their friend, and that is as true for you as it is for your child. As a mother, if you spend your time only with non-Muslim parents,

or with Muslims who don't practice, your standards will drop very fast.

The Prophet ﷺ said:

"The example of a good companion and a bad companion is like the seller of musk and the one who blows the blacksmith's bellows. The seller of musk will either give you some, or you will buy some from him, or you will smell a pleasant scent from him. The one who blows the bellows will either burn your clothes, or you will smell a bad smell from him."

MUSLIM

Think about it. If a mother spends most of her time with parents whose kids are always misbehaving and struggling with Salah, she slowly starts to see it as normal. She thinks, "Oh well, all kids are like this." Then she sees non-Muslim children behaving even worse, and she thinks, "Well, at least my kids don't do that." She settles for where she is. Maybe she makes a weak attempt to improve, but the real fire is gone. That is the low, stuck standard this dunya wants her to accept, and she does not even notice it happening.

Now picture the same mother with a different circle of friends. These are mothers whose children pray regularly, show kindness and mercy to each other, and are memorizing the Quran. Will her standards stay the

same? Absolutely not. Her new circle will expect more from her, and they expect more from their own lives too. Remember this, sister: we either sink or rise to the expectations of the people around us.

Just being in the company of such mothers will lift her up. The things she once tolerated in herself will become unacceptable to her, and her bar will be set higher. Her dreams, her goals, and her hopes will change in a big way.

Great visions need a great purpose

In the masterclass, I asked you one question: when your child prays, are they praying for Allah, or to get you off their back? Now let me ask you the same thing about yourself. My purpose for praying can be only to avoid punishment. Or my purpose for praying five times a day can be to earn the love of Allah and to avoid punishment. It is the same action with a different purpose. Do you think the purpose we focus on changes whether we act, and how we act? Absolutely, it does.

A few years ago, I wrote a book for children called "Discover the Power of Salah." At first, I believed this book would help children, and that was it. But then the emails and messages started coming in from mothers, and they amazed me. They shared stories of children who went from being lazy in prayer to waking their parents up for Fajr and giving the Adhan in their homes.

For me, this was one more proof of the power of purpose. That book did not lecture their minds; it steered their hearts. It explained the purpose of Salah in detail, and it painted a clear picture of what life could look like with Salah, in this world and in the next. It gave them a vision of having Allah as their closest companion through life. It gave them a vision of

being people devoted to prayer, of seeing the face of Allah, and of sitting on golden stools on the day of Eid in Jannah. These great dreams breathed new life into their Salah, and nobody had to push them.

So let me ask you something. Do you still have great dreams that ignite your drive? Do your dreams need new life? Do you find it hard to dream big, the way you once did as a child?

Great actions need a grand vision and a great purpose. An extraordinary mother needs an extraordinary purpose and an extraordinary dream.

So let me share with you the stories of five remarkable mothers. Each one had an extraordinary vision for her child, and each one knew how to steer his heart until that vision became real.

01

THE FIRST MOTHER

Imam Ahmad's Mother

Let's begin with the mother of Imam Ahmad. She was a single mother living in poverty, but she had a dream to raise a strong Muslim child who would be of great benefit to the world. She did not let her circumstances get in the way of her vision and her mission, and she never let any of it become an excuse to give up.

Every single day, she woke up long before Fajr to warm water for her son. She dressed him, and then she guided him through the dark alleys to the mosque. Her goal was to make sure he stood in the front row, even though there was no man in the family to guide him inside. Then she waited patiently while he sat in the Halaqa of Hadith after Fajr. She was determined to give her little boy every chance to learn from the scholars.

Imam Ahmad's mother was an incredible and devoted mother who refused to let excuses or obstacles stand between her and her dream. And she succeeded in raising a great scholar, a man who became a guiding light for the whole ummah.

02

THE SECOND MOTHER

Imam Malik's Mother

When Imam Malik was a child, he wanted to be a singer. Does that sound familiar? Today, many of us are hearing, "Mama, I want to be a YouTuber."

His mother could have simply dismissed his dream and said, "No, that's a waste of time." But she chose a different approach, one that would shape his purpose for the rest of his life.

With great wisdom, she sat him down and had a heartfelt conversation with him. She said:

"If you become a singer, there will be a time when your voice and your looks will fade. For a singer, these two things are very important. When you lose them, nobody will pay attention to you anymore. No one will respect you or honour you."

Look at what she did here, because she did not lecture his mind. Instead of just reacting to him, she stopped and reflected on why this little boy wanted this. She found the hunger underneath his wish, the hunger to be respected and honoured, and then she spoke directly to that need.

Then she added:

"But if you gain knowledge and become a scholar instead, then as you grow older, that knowledge will increase, and so will the respect and the honour."

She empathised with his need and his desire, and then she showed him another path, one that would give him what he truly wanted, and for much longer. This is exactly what steering the heart looks like: you cannot lecture a belief into changing, but you can show a child that what he really wants is waiting for him on a better road.

But she did not stop there. She would direct him to go and learn from different scholars. She told him to go to this person for this knowledge, and to that person for that knowledge. One of the scholars she sent him to was Rabi'ah ar Ra'i, and she said to her son, "Learn from his manners before you learn from his knowledge."

Now, how did this woman even know which scholar was best for which knowledge? She had done her research. She had built her awareness of the best teachers her son could learn from. She had planned and prepared for this journey long before Imam Malik was ready to begin it.

Then the day finally came for Imam Malik to go and seek more knowledge. He came to his mother full of excitement and asked, "Mother, can I go and gather more knowledge now?" Her response was profound. She said, "Yes, but first, come here and put on a scholar's clothes." She dressed him in an elaborate outfit, with a long cloth on his head and a lengthened turban. Then, with great conviction, she said, "Now, you go and gather knowledge."

Do you see what she did with this one simple act? She planted a deep respect for knowledge in his heart, and a deep respect for the role of a seeker of knowledge. She primed his mindset for the magnificent mission ahead of him. Her love, her guidance, and her careful preparation laid the foundation for his remarkable success. And notice who was doing the asking, because nobody had to push him; he was the one begging to go.

THE THIRD MOTHER

Imam Bukhari's Mother

Imam Bukhari's mother was a very knowledgeable woman. After her husband passed away, she chose not to remarry. Instead, she made a conscious decision to devote herself completely to the upbringing of her son. Her deep understanding and wisdom guided every step she took.

At the tender age of twelve, Imam Bukhari faced a great trial when he lost his eyesight. Imagine the fear in a mother's heart. But this mother had unshakable faith, and she poured her heart into sincere duas to Allah. Her prayers were answered. After two years, his eyesight was miraculously restored. This miracle allowed him to serve the ummah through the teachings of Hadith, reading it, writing it, and learning its deep wisdom.

Even as a small child, Imam Bukhari showed extraordinary dedication. By the age of six, he had already memorized the entire Quran, which speaks to his mother's guidance and to his own commitment to seeking knowledge.

Then she took the decisive step of sending him to gatherings where scholars met to study and discuss hadith. It was in those gatherings that his love for the science of Hadith bloomed, and it set him on a path of learning and scholarship.

04

THE FOURTH MOTHER

Imam Shafi's Mother

Get ready, sister, because this is a story of extraordinary strength.

Despite being a poor single mother, this mother made a long journey with her son from Palestine to Makkah, with a great vision in her heart for his future. This was not a quick plane ride. It was an extremely difficult journey for a woman alone with her child, but she did not let those challenges block her way. Driven by her vision, she wanted to make sure her child had access to the best scholars in Makkah.

As a young boy, he and his mother were so poor that they could not even afford to buy paper. Still, she did not give up on the great dream.

The book "Etiquettes of Knowledge" describes a beautiful story of this mother's zest. When her son reached his teenage years, he came to his widowed mother one day and told her he wanted to leave Makkah and go to Madinah to learn Hadith. When she heard this, she burst into tears.

When her son saw his mother shed a river of tears, he said to her, "If it pains you so much, I will not go. I will stay here and learn from the best here."

"I am crying because this is the answer to all those duas I made to my Rabb, crying all night at tahajjud, that Allah swt gives you the love of knowledge and makes you a light for the creations of Allah till the Day of Judgment."

Sister, this mother was no great scholar herself, yet she raised a son who surpassed her, because she knew how to steer the heart. This is what I told you in the masterclass: when you learn to steer the heart, the heart goes further than you ever went. You do not have to be a perfect Muslim to raise a great one.

05

THE FIFTH MOTHER

Rabi'ah's Mother

The last mother I want to share with you is the mother of Rabi'ah, a great scholar of his time. You may remember him, because he was the scholar that Imam Malik's mother sent her son to learn from.

When Rabi'ah's mother was pregnant with him, his father left them, and he left them with 30,000 dirhams.

Thirty years later, when Rabi'ah's father finally returned home, he found a young man inside the house, a complete stranger to him. Neither of them recognized the other, and confusion soon turned into an argument. The father could not understand why this man claimed the house as his own. In the middle of this conflict, the mother stepped in and revealed to Rabi'ah that the stranger was, in fact, his father. And so the father and son were reunited.

Later, the father asked her, "What did you do with the 30,000 dirhams I left you?"

She said, "I will tell you tomorrow."

These Were Not Accidents

Life was not easy for these women. Many of them were single mothers, many lived in poverty, and their lives were filled with real obstacles. But their unwavering commitment paved the way for their children to become beacons of light, filling the world with wisdom and leadership.

Here is the secret, sister. These mothers' hearts were not pushed; they were pulled toward a grand vision, a dream so big that it carried them forward every day. It was that big dream, that great vision, which opened the path to incredible success for them and for their children.

<https://66ada66a-6044-49ca-9f1d-bc260672d01d.claudeuserconte...-49ca-9f1d-bc260672d01d/serve/Stories%20of%20Mothers.dc.html>

A MOMENT FOR YOU

So let me ask you:

- What is your great dream?

- What is your vision for your children?

- Do you have a BIG dream, like Imam Shafi's mother, that you make dua for every day?

- Is there a vision for your children that pulls you every day? Or do you find yourself pushing yourself every day?

So how do you nourish your dream?

In the masterclass, I told you there is no sabr without hope, without anticipation, without a picture of the future. That is how you survived nine months and all those sleepless nights: you were waiting to see their face one day. A dream, a great vision, WILL pull you. It WILL drive you, keep you laser-focused, and help you become the person you need to become to achieve it. But even a dream needs care and nourishment to stay alive. Without it, the dream will die in your heart and leave only heartache behind.

Page 22 of 30

If you don't want your dream to fade, or let life's unpredictable circumstances steal it from you, you need to keep your focus on it. The best way to do that is to make it a constant part of your duas. You can also write it down and read it every day. By staying connected to your dream, you keep the clarity and motivation you need to pursue it.

If you need a place to start, go back to the picture we painted together in the masterclass. Your children praying on their own. Opening the Quran on their own. Choosing good friends. Hugging you one day and saying, "Thank you, Mom. I know it wasn't easy, but you never gave up on me." Hold on to that image, sister. It is what will fuel your patience.

2 Strengthen it

If you find that your dua is becoming routine, and your heart is no longer as desperate for it as it once was, then it's time to raise your dua. Make an even bigger dua, and revive it. Remember, this is a grand dream and a long journey. You may face setbacks, but after every dip, rise higher and renew your determination.

3 Become it

Understand this: the person you become while pursuing your dream is even more important than the dream itself. Whether that dream comes true by the end of this life is not in your hands. But today, right now, you can decide to live the life of a mother who worked all her life to make her dream a reality for the sake of Allah.

Whether your child becomes Imam Shafi tomorrow is not in your control. But right at this moment, you can decide to live like Imam Shafi's mother.

Each step you take toward your dream is shaping you in a certain way, into a certain character, the character of a great Muslim woman. Each step is shaping your identity, not as just any parent, but as a strong parent, a strong Muslim with a great purpose. You were built for this. Allah chose you to be the mother of this child, and that was not a random coincidence.

A MOMENT FOR YOU

Ask yourself:

- What kind of person do I need to become to make this dream a reality?

- What does that person do every day?

- What does that person never do?

- What are the MUSTS for this person?

- What does this person refuse to tolerate in life, from herself and from others?

- Who is this person?

Write down your answers. It's a long journey, so start living one answer at a time.

4 Bring it to life

Each step you take toward your dream fuels its existence and makes it stronger and more alive. The moment you start walking toward your dream, you will grow, and your dream will grow right alongside you.

Nourish your dreams, sister. Keep them alive, and let them guide you on your journey. Embrace the power of your vision, and watch as it carries you and your children toward greatness.

ONE LAST THING, SISTER

You Are a Shepherd Too

Every mother in this book was a shepherd. Not a manager, suffocating her child and exhausting herself. Not a dictator, whipping him along. She had a vision, she knew how to steer the heart, and she walked ahead of her flock until her son became a light for the ummah.

The Prophet ﷺ said that every one of you is a shepherd, and that shepherd is already inside you, sister. Allah placed her there on the very day He gave you your child, because you were built for this.

But here is the truth. Reading about shepherds today does not make you one today, and neither did ninety minutes with me. This requires training. You were handed an old roadmap for a world where the roads have completely changed, and that is all we are fixing.

Hope is not a strategy, sister. The heart must be actively steered and protected from the wolves, and if you do not become the shepherd, the wolves are ready.

That is exactly why I created the Shepherd's Coaching Roadmap. It is the new roadmap to raise unshakable Muslims in a new world, and it turns everything you learned in the masterclass into daily, doable actions.

Inside, we walk the three pillars together:

- So which mother are you going to be? The one who says, "This was lovely, I learned so much," and goes back to the same struggle next week? Or the doer? Remember Hajar, who did not sit and hope. She ran between Safa and Marwah again and again, and Allah did not abandon her, and He will not abandon you either.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Join the Shepherd's Coaching Roadmap

emaanpower.com/roadmap

*May Allah make you a shepherd whose
children become lights for this ummah.
Ameen.*